

ME 333
MECHANICS OF MATERIALS

Lecture 5: Principal Strains & Compatibility Relations
Tutorial 1 - Concept of Strain

Ravi Sastri Ayyagari

Mechanical Engineering
Indian Institute of Technology Gandhinagar

Sem I, 2025-2026

Principal Components - Eigen Values

Principal Strains

- Considering the eigen value problem:

$$\det(\epsilon - \lambda I) = \begin{vmatrix} \epsilon_{xx} - \lambda & \epsilon_{xy} & \epsilon_{xz} \\ \epsilon_{yx} & \epsilon_{yy} - \lambda & \epsilon_{yz} \\ \epsilon_{zx} & \epsilon_{zy} & \epsilon_{zz} - \lambda \end{vmatrix} = 0$$

Note that $\lambda = M$ (magnification factor). M_1, M_2 and M_3 are the three eigen values.

- The eigen vectors correspond to the principal directions.
- Strain Invariants:

$$\bar{I}_1 = \text{tr}(\epsilon) = \epsilon_{xx} + \epsilon_{yy} + \epsilon_{zz}$$

$$\bar{I}_2 = \epsilon_{xx}\epsilon_{yy} + \epsilon_{yy}\epsilon_{zz} + \epsilon_{xx}\epsilon_{zz} - \epsilon_{xy}^2 - \epsilon_{yz}^2 - \epsilon_{xz}^2$$

$$\bar{I}_3 = \det(\epsilon)$$

Principal Strains

[Example 4] Determine the principal strains and associated directions.

$$\epsilon = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 5 \\ 2 & 4 \end{bmatrix}$$

- Step 1: Determine eigen values:

$$\det(\epsilon) = \begin{vmatrix} 1 - \lambda & 5 \\ 2 & 4 - \lambda \end{vmatrix} = 0 \implies (\lambda + 1)(\lambda - 6) = 0 \implies \lambda_1 = 6, \lambda_2 = -1$$

- Step 2: Determine eigen vectors:

$$(\epsilon - \lambda_1 I)x_1 = \begin{bmatrix} -5 & 5 \\ 2 & -2 \end{bmatrix} \begin{Bmatrix} x \\ y \end{Bmatrix} = 0 \implies \begin{Bmatrix} x \\ y \end{Bmatrix} = \begin{Bmatrix} \pm(1/\sqrt{2}) \\ \pm(1/\sqrt{2}) \end{Bmatrix}$$

Note : Do not forget to normalize.

Review of Basics of Tensors

Q What is rank of a matrix?

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 2 & 1 \\ 0 & 2 & 4 & 2 \\ 0 & 2 & 2 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

Rank : Maximum of number of linearly independent column vectors, Rank(A) = 3

Q For a tensor is order same as rank akin that of a matrix?

NO

Generalized Strain Description

Q If every displacement field Δ is not unique then are all such Δ valid ?

Navigation icons

Strain Compatibility Relations

Planar Small Strain Theory

- The strain - displacement relations can be written as:

$$\epsilon_{xx} = \frac{\partial u}{\partial x}; \quad \epsilon_{yy} = \frac{\partial v}{\partial y}; \quad \epsilon_{xy} = \frac{1}{2} \left(\frac{\partial v}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial u}{\partial y} \right)$$

- Considering strains in $x - y$ plane, differentiating as below :

$$\frac{\partial^2 \epsilon_{xx}}{\partial y^2} = \frac{\partial^3 u}{\partial x \partial y^2}; \quad \frac{\partial^2 \epsilon_{yy}}{\partial x^2} = \frac{\partial^3 v}{\partial x^2 \partial y}; \quad 2 \frac{\partial^2 \epsilon_{xy}}{\partial x \partial y} = \frac{\partial^3 u}{\partial x \partial y^2} + \frac{\partial^3 v}{\partial x^2 \partial y}$$

- The relation between the normal and shear strain components is:

$$\frac{\partial^2 \epsilon_{xx}}{\partial y^2} + \frac{\partial^2 \epsilon_{yy}}{\partial x^2} = 2 \frac{\partial^2 \epsilon_{xy}}{\partial x \partial y}$$

Navigation icons

Strain Compatibility Relations

- In a full three dimensional setting:

$$\epsilon_{xx,yy} + \epsilon_{yy,xx} = 2\epsilon_{xy,xy}$$

$$\epsilon_{yy,zz} + \epsilon_{zz,yy} = 2\epsilon_{yz,yz}$$

$$\epsilon_{zz,xx} + \epsilon_{xx,zz} = 2\epsilon_{xz,xz}$$

$$\epsilon_{zz,xy} + \epsilon_{xy,zz} = \epsilon_{yz,zx} + \epsilon_{zx,yz}$$

$$\epsilon_{yy,xz} + \epsilon_{xz,yy} = \epsilon_{yz,yx} + \epsilon_{xy,yz}$$

$$\epsilon_{xx,yz} + \epsilon_{yz,xx} = \epsilon_{xz,xy} + \epsilon_{xy,xz}$$

- These six relations are known as *Compatibility Relations*
- Note that in the above set of equations the $(,)$ is used to denote partial differentiation with respect to the subscripts following the comma.

Navigation icons

Strain Compatibility Relations

[Example 1] Is the given plane strain state permissible:

$$\epsilon_{xx} = k(x^2 + y^2); \quad \epsilon_{yy} = k(y^2 + x^2); \quad \epsilon_{xy} = k'xyz$$

where k and k' are small constants.

In the plane strain state $\epsilon_{zz} = \epsilon_{xz} = \epsilon_{yz} = 0$ and therefore the number of compatibility equations reduce to one.

$$\epsilon_{xx,yy} + \epsilon_{yy,xx} = 2\epsilon_{xy,xy} \implies 2k + 2k = 2k'z \implies (2k/k') = z$$

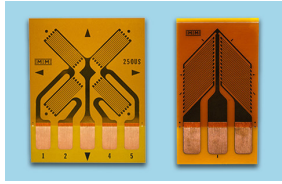
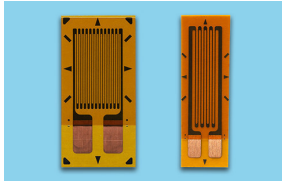
From above, the LHS is a constant while RHS is a variable and therefore, the strain state is *not* permissible.

Navigation icons

Measurement of Strain

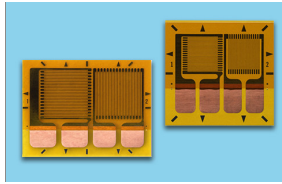
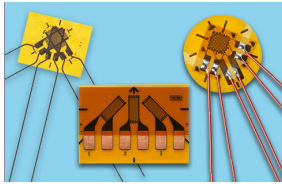
Strain Gages and Strain Rosette

Linear Patterns



Shear/Torque Rosettes

Rectangular Rosettes



Tee Rosettes

Ref Figs: Vishay Micro-measurements

ravi.ayyagari@iitgn.ac.in

ME 333

Sem I, 2025-2026

9 / 19

Measurement of Strain

Strain Rosette

- The strain transformation equations are:

$$\epsilon_a = \frac{\epsilon_x + \epsilon_y}{2} + \frac{\epsilon_x - \epsilon_y}{2} \cos 2\theta_a + \frac{\gamma_{xy}}{2} \sin 2\theta_a$$

$$\epsilon_b = \frac{\epsilon_x + \epsilon_y}{2} + \frac{\epsilon_x - \epsilon_y}{2} \cos 2\theta_b + \frac{\gamma_{xy}}{2} \sin 2\theta_b$$

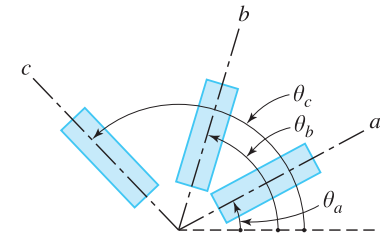
$$\epsilon_c = \frac{\epsilon_x + \epsilon_y}{2} + \frac{\epsilon_x - \epsilon_y}{2} \cos 2\theta_c + \frac{\gamma_{xy}}{2} \sin 2\theta_c$$

- Note that the same can be obtained using:

$$\epsilon_a = l_1^2 \epsilon_x + m_1^2 \epsilon_y + 2l_1 m_1 \epsilon_{xy}$$

⋮

- Two configurations of strain rosette are most typically used which are:
0° – 45° – 90°, 0° – 60° – 120° configurations.



Ref: An Introduction to Mechanics of Solids, Crandall et. al.

ravi.ayyagari@iitgn.ac.in

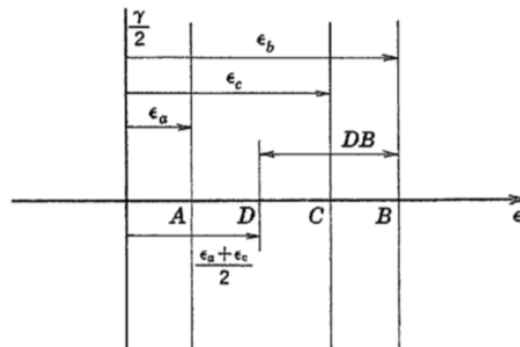
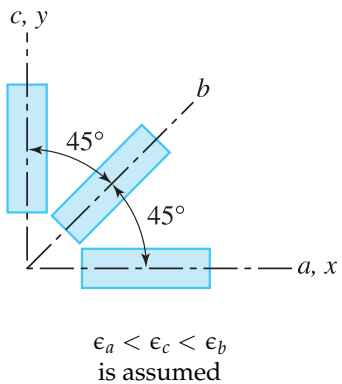
ME 333

Sem I, 2025-2026

10 / 19

Mohr's Circle for Strain

Strain Rosette Example : [Example 4.4]



Ref: An Introduction to Mechanics of Solids, Crandall et. al.

ravi.ayyagari@iitgn.ac.in

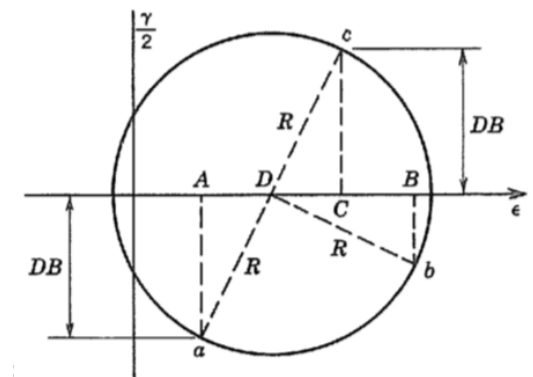
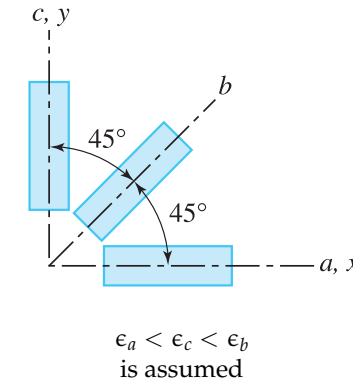
ME 333

Sem I, 2025-2026

11 / 19

Mohr's Circle for Strain

Strain Rosette Example : [Example 4.4]



Ref: An Introduction to Mechanics of Solids, Crandall et. al.

ravi.ayyagari@iitgn.ac.in

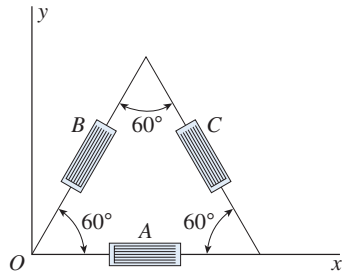
ME 333

Sem I, 2025-2026

12 / 19

Mohr's Circle for Strain

Strain Rosette : [Example 2] A 60° strain rosette (delta rosette) is used to measure strains ϵ_a , ϵ_b and ϵ_c , along three directions A , B and C , respectively, as shown. Obtain ϵ_{xx} , ϵ_{yy} and ϵ_{xy} .



- **Step 1:** Using transformation relations:

$$\text{For } \theta = 0^\circ : l_1 = 1, m_1 = 0 \implies \epsilon_A = \epsilon_{xx}$$

$$\text{For } \theta = 60^\circ : l_1 = 1/2, m_1 = \sqrt{3}/2$$

$$\epsilon_B = \frac{\epsilon_{xx}}{4} + \frac{3\epsilon_{yy}}{4} + \frac{\sqrt{3}\epsilon_{xy}}{2}$$

$$\text{For } \theta = 120^\circ : l_1 = -1/2, m_1 = \sqrt{3}/2$$

$$\epsilon_C = \frac{\epsilon_{xx}}{4} + \frac{3\epsilon_{yy}}{4} - \frac{\sqrt{3}\epsilon_{xy}}{2}$$

Ref: Mechanics of Materials, James M. Gere & Barry J. Goodno

ravi.ayyagari@iitgn.ac.in

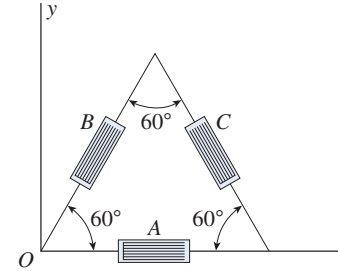
ME 333

Sem I, 2025-2026

13 / 19

Mohr's Circle for Strain

Strain Rosette : [Example 2] (Contd ...)



- **Step 2:** Solve for the remaining two unknowns, we get:

$$\epsilon_{yy} = \frac{1}{3} (2\epsilon_B + 2\epsilon_C - \epsilon_A)$$

$$\epsilon_{xy} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{3}} (\epsilon_B - \epsilon_C)$$

Ref: Mechanics of Materials, James M. Gere & Barry J. Goodno

ravi.ayyagari@iitgn.ac.in

ME 333

Sem I, 2025-2026

14 / 19

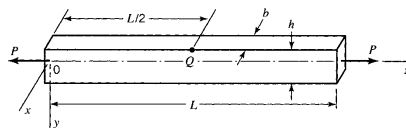
Tutorial Problems

Tutorial Problems

[Problem 2.53] The tension member shown has the following dimensions: $L = 5$ m, $b = 100$ mm and $h = 200$ mm. The (x, y, z) coordinate axes are parallel to the edges of the member, with origin O located at the centroid of the left end. Under the deformation produced by the load P , the origin O remains located at the centroid of the left end and the coordinate axes remain parallel to the edges of the deformed member. Under the action of load P , the bar elongates 20 mm. Assume that the volume of the bar remains constant with $\epsilon_{xx} = \epsilon_{yy}$.

- 1 Determine the displacements for the member and the state of strain at point Q , assuming small strain theory.

- 2 Determine ϵ_{zz} at point Q based on the assumption that the displacements are not small.



Ref: Mechanics of Materials, James M. Gere & Barry J. Goodno

ravi.ayyagari@iitgn.ac.in

ME 333

Sem I, 2025-2026

15 / 19

Tutorial Problems

Tutorial Problems

[Problem 2.53] Solution :

Answer : a) $u = -0.002x$, $v = -0.002y$ and $w = 0.004z$; b) $\epsilon_{zz} = 0.004008$ valid at all points of the body.

Ref: Mechanics of Materials, James M. Gere & Barry J. Goodno

ravi.ayyagari@iitgn.ac.in

ME 333

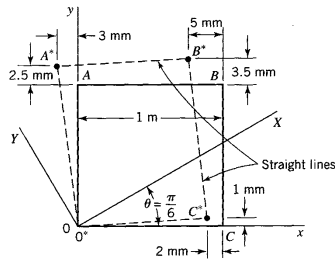
Sem I, 2025-2026

16 / 19

Tutorial Problems

[Problem 2.56] A square glass block in the side of a skyscraper is loaded so that the block is in a state of plane strain ($\epsilon_{zz} = \epsilon_{zx} = \epsilon_{zy} = 0$).

- 1 Determine the displacements in the block for the deformations shown and the strain components for the (x, y) coordinate axes.
- 2 Determine the strain components for the (X, Y) axes.



Tutorial Problems

[Problem 2.56] Solution :

Answer : a) $u = -0.002x - 0.003y$, $v = 0.001x + 0.0025y$; b) $\epsilon_{XX} = -0.00174$, $\epsilon_{YY} = 0.00224$ and $\epsilon_{XY} = 0.00145$.

Reading Assignment

Chapter 2: Sections 2.7 - 2.9